

This is unreleased documentation for Serverpod **Next** version.

For up-to-date documentation, see the [latest version](#) (4.0.0).

3.1.1

CHOOSING A STRATEGY

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Choosing a strategy

You can run a Serverpod server anywhere that supports a Dart process or a Docker container: a managed server cluster, a serverless platform, or your own machine. This page covers the trade-offs. For the managed path, see [Serverpod Cloud](#).

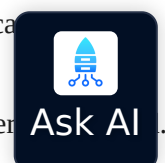
Server cluster or serverless?

The two main options are running on a cluster of servers or on a serverless platform. Run on a **cluster** (such as Google Cloud Engine) if your server holds state. Run **serverless** (such as Google Cloud Run) if your server is stateless. An example of a stateful server is [Pixorama](#), where the server keeps live state in memory. If you only make API calls that read and write a database, serverless may be the better fit.

	Server cluster	Serverless
Pros	All features are supported. Great for real-time communication. Cost-efficient at scale.	Minimal starting cost. Easier configuration. Minimal maintenance.
Cons	Slightly higher starting cost. More complex to set up.	Limited feature set. The server cannot hold state.

Serverless does not support:

- Future calls. (Possible to configure, but requires a more advanced setup.)
- Health metrics.
- On-server caching. Caching can still happen while a serverless instance stays warm, but it can't happen any time. Caching with Redis is supported.
- In-memory state. Store shared state in an external service such as Postgres, Redis, or another database.



Pick a guide

- [Hosting elsewhere](#): run Serverpod on any Dart or Docker host.
- [Community-supported deployments](#): tools built by the community.

Approximate costs

A minimal **server cluster** on Google Cloud Platform:

Service	Min cost
Compute Engine Instance	\$7 / mo
Cloud Load Balancing	\$19 / mo
Cloud SQL for PostgreSQL	\$10 / mo

A minimal **serverless** setup on Google Cloud Run, where you only pay for the traffic you serve and no load balancer is required:

Service	Min cost
Cloud Run	\$0 / mo
Cloud SQL for PostgreSQL	\$10 / mo

INFO

These prices are rough approximations to give you a sense of hosting costs. Actual costs vary and change over time. Do your own research before provisioning infrastructure.